

Rain Garden Observation Notebook

Compare drainage time in three soil samples. Record what happened before deciding why.

240 mL / the same water volume for every sample

In this fictional classroom investigation, three equal containers hold sand, garden soil and clay-rich soil. Each receives the same water volume; students time the first 100 mL collected.

Sample	Trial Times	Median
Sand	38 / 41 / 40 sec	40 sec
Garden soil	84 / 90 / 87 sec	87 sec
Clay-rich soil	165 / 172 / 168 sec	168 sec
Keep the Test Fair Use the same container size, water volume and timing method. Repeat each sample three times. Describe any spills or delayed starts.	Read the Pattern Sand drained fastest in the sample results. The test measures this setup only; it does not establish how an entire garden will behave.	Ask a Better Question How would compaction change the result? Plan one change at a time and state which measurement would answer your question.

Synthetic classroom observations • Follow your teacher's safety instructions.